

Typically, motion capture files record keys at every frame. Biped lets you filter the data as it is applied to the Biped as well as extract footsteps for footstep animation. Motion capture is managed by using the Motion Capture rollout.

Motion capture is imported by using the Load Motion Capture File option in the Motion Capture rollout. 3ds Max supports Biovision (.bvh) and Character Studio (.csm) marker files. When a file is selected, the Motion Capture Conversion Parameters window applies the marker data to parameters that you set. The Motion Capture rollout allows you to load motion capture files and fit the Biped to the talent used for motion capture.

Setting used to After motion capture data is imported into 3ds Max, it can be edited by using the Animation Workbench. Edited motion capture can then be saved in 3ds Max's Biped (.bip) format. A motion that has been converted to Biped format can then be applied to any Biped, regardless of its size and scale.

8.4.4 Motion Flow Mode

Motion Flow uses BIP files as clips in a script. The motion-flow script joins clips together by using transitions. Transitions can be unconditional, chosen at random, or governed by rules such as collision detection. You can control when a transition begins and ends. You can use Motion Flow to animate a single Biped or a crowd of Bipedes.

The Motion Flow rollout allows creating and saving motion scripts. The Motion Flow Graph window is where biped motions can be connected together to create transitions.

8.5 Motion Mixer

The Motion Mixer allows you to combine motion clips for both Biped and non-biped objects. It works very similarly to a nonlinear video editor. Motion is contained in clips, which can contain entire Biped motions or the motions for a single object. Clips are loaded into tracks, which allow you to adjust timing as well as mix transitions from clip to clip. The Motion Mixer lets you to work with animation above the level of the key frame. Motion Mixer is used mostly with motion capture files to mix and combine the various takes to create an entire motion. Traditional key frame animation can also be stored as clips for more-stylized motion. Clips are stored as individual files and are loaded into tracks.

- **Track**

A track can hold multiple clips. Top tracks are processed first.